

**Acceptable Password Characters**

| Character category                                                                                    | Examples                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Uppercase letters                                                                                     | A, B, C                                                          |
| Lowercase letters                                                                                     | a, b, c                                                          |
| Numbers                                                                                               | 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9                                     |
| Symbols found on the keyboard (all keyboard characters not defined as letters or numerals) and spaces | ` ~ ! @ # \$ % ^ & * ( ) _ - + = { } [ ] \   : ; " ' < > , . ? / |

A password might meet all the criteria above and still be a weak password. For example, Hello2U! meets all the criteria for a strong password listed above, but is still weak because it contains a complete word. H3ll0 2 U! is a stronger alternative because it replaces some of the letters in the complete word with numbers and also includes spaces.

Help yourself remember your strong password by following these tips:

- Create an acronym from an easy-to-remember piece of information. For example, pick a phrase that is meaningful to you, such as “My son’s birthday is 12 December, 2004.” Using that phrase as your guide, you might use Msbi12/Dec,4 for your password
- Substitute numbers, symbols, and misspellings for letters or words in an easy-to-remember phrase. For example, “My son’s birthday is 12 December, 2004” could become Mi\$un’s Brthd8iz 12124 (it’s OK to use spaces in your password)
- Relate your password to a favourite hobby or sport. For example, “I love to play badminton” could become ILuv2PlayB@dm1nt(n

If you feel you must write down your password in order to remember it, make sure you don’t label it as your password, and keep it in a safe place.